

9-TIME WORLD SERIES CHAMPIONS: 1903, 1912, 1915, 1916, 1918, 2004, 2007, 2013, 2018

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BOSTON RED SOX (52-48, 3rd AL East) vs. BALTIMORE ORIOLES (49-53) — GAME 2 TONIGHT

Fenway Park • Boston won Game 1, 7-3(*), tying the 1946 Red Sox for the longest winning streak in franchise history at **15 straight** — a Game 2 win tonight would break the record outright at 16

GAME 1 FINAL: Red Sox 7, Orioles 3(*) — Jake Bennett (W, 6-3) worked 5.2 IP, allowing 9 H and 3 ER with 4 K; Caleb Durbin (2-run double) and Jarren Duran (2-run triple) delivered the decisive early cluster off Dean Kremer (L). Garrett Whitlock finished it off. Defense held up despite gusty winds blowing out to left-center.

GAME 2, 7:10 p.m. ET (5:10 p.m. MT): LHP Ranger Suárez (BOS, 4-3, 3.15) — activated off the 15-day IL — vs. RHP Kyle Bradish (BAL, 6-9, 3.61). Suárez is 0-2, 4.32 ERA in four career starts against Baltimore; Bradish is 1-6, 6.75 ERA in 10 career starts against Boston.

(*) Game 1's final score is reconstructed from the confirmed recap details (Bennett's line, Durbin's and Duran's RBI hits, final record of 52-48) rather than a box score explicitly stating the line score — treat 7-3 as approximate. Every other Game 1 detail here is confirmed.

Next: Blue Jays at Fenway (7/24–26), then a 4-game set at the Athletics in West Sacramento (7/27–30) — trade deadline is Mon., Aug. 3

STATE OF THE SOX

- Boston is 52-48 (3rd, AL East, 6.0 GB) with the winning streak now at **15 games**, tying the 1946 club for the longest in franchise history. A Game 2 win tonight breaks it outright at 16.
- At four games over .500, the Sox are as far above the break-even line as they've been all season — and climbing with every out tonight.
- Boston has won 20 of its last 22 and holds the American League's third and final Wild Card spot outright, 1.0 game clear of Seattle.
- The climb continues: the Sox sat 15.5 games back on June 24, the low point of the season. Today, 28 days later, they are 6.0 back — 9.5 games of ground recovered.

GAME 1: BENNETT AND THE KIDS TIE THE GHOST

- Jake Bennett (W, 6-3) went 5.2 innings, allowing 9 hits and 3 earned runs with 4 strikeouts — not his cleanest outing, but plenty with the offense he had behind him. Garrett Whitlock closed it out.
- Caleb Durbin's two-run double and Jarren Duran's two-run triple staked Boston to an early cushion the Orioles never threatened; Durbin's now hitting .351 over his last 10 games and Duran's power/speed game

RED SOX HEADLINES**Red Sox tie 1946 club for longest winning streak in franchise history**

Jake Bennett worked around a shaky final line and an early cluster from Caleb Durbin and Jarren Duran carried Boston past Baltimore in Game 1 of today's doubleheader, tying the 1946 Red Sox at 15 straight. Game 2 tonight is for the record outright.

Boston.com • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

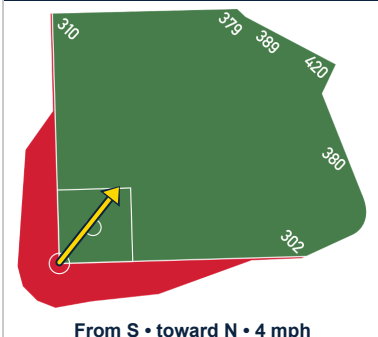
Suárez activated, gets the ball for Game 2 as Red Sox chase No. 16

Boston reinstated Ranger Suárez from the 15-day IL ahead of tonight's nightcap against Baltimore, opting for the veteran lefty over rookie Eduardo Rivera with a chance at an outright franchise-record 16th straight win on the line.

Yardbarker (Field Level Media) • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

FENWAY WEATHER

TEMP 74°F	WIND S 4 mph
GUSTS 8 mph	FEELS LIKE 80°F
PARK WIND Light Breeze — Blowing Out, Left-Center	
Today: Light Drizzle, high 84°F / low 67°F, 40% chance of rain. Live via Open-Meteo • updates when this page is opened	

LIVE WIND @ FENWAY**2026 SEASON SNAPSHOT**

Overall 52-48 (.520)

- came with a rare well-timed knock to match it.
- The defense held up "despite gusty winds blowing out to left-center," per the recap — a forecast our own live wind widget on this page would have called correctly today.
 - Fifteen straight ties the 1946 Red Sox (Apr. 25–May 10) for the longest winning streak in the 126-year history of the franchise — the Ted Williams/Bobby Doerr/Dom DiMaggio/Johnny Pesky club that won the pennant but lost a seven-game World Series to St. Louis, sealed by Enos Slaughter's "Mad Dash" on Harry Walker's Game 7 double. Even the 108-win 2018 club topped out at 10 in a row; the 2017 Cleveland Indians hold the all-time MLB record at 22.

ONE WIN FROM HISTORY

- Ranger Suárez has been activated off the 15-day IL and gets the ball for Game 2 against Kyle Bradish, 7:10 p.m. ET — a win makes this the longest winning streak in Red Sox history, outright, at 16.
- Suárez is 0-2 with a 4.32 ERA in four career starts against Baltimore; Bradish is 1-6 with a 6.75 ERA in 10 career starts against Boston but is coming off a strong July 11 outing (6.2 IP, 1 R) against Kansas City.
- Willson Contreras, on the streak: "It would mean a lot, for sure... we are relentless, we are resilient. If it happens it would be great for us and we'll have to celebrate that. If it doesn't, we have to keep going."

THE TWO-RUN TOURNQUET

- Hold the other team to two runs or fewer and this season is essentially decided: Boston is still **34-1** in those games (neither Monday's five-run Baltimore output nor today's Game 1 three-run output qualifies). The lone blemish remains the May 12 loss to Philadelphia.
- Today's Game 1 was the second straight game the pitching staff allowed 3+ runs, but the offense has more than covered for it across the 15-game run.

THE 5-RUN RECIPE

- Boston is now **38-9** when it scores five or more and 14-39 when it doesn't — today's seven runs(*) kept the streak living on the right side of that split for the 15th straight time.

FENWAY, STILL A RIDDLE — BUT CLOSING

- Today's win was a home game, nudging the home ledger to 23-27 against a 29-21 road mark — the reverse split is down to six games. Eight of the next 11 are at Fenway, including tonight, so the window to keep closing it remains open.

BALTIMORE, REVISITED

Durbin, Duran power early cluster as Boston moves within one win of history

A two-run double from Caleb Durbin and a two-run triple from Jarren Duran staked the Red Sox to an early lead they never gave back, backing a gritty if imperfect Jake Bennett start in Boston's 15th consecutive win.

NBC Sports Boston • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

Only one Red Sox team has ever won more in a row — and Boston just matched it

The 1946 club won 15 straight from late April into May behind Ted Williams, Bobby Doerr and Johnny Pesky, then lost a seven-game World Series to St. Louis — a reminder that this record has a bittersweet history attached to it as today's team ties the mark.

NESN • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

'Can you believe it': Fenway reacts as Red Sox tie the ghost of '46

A team that was 15.5 games back a month ago is one win from the longest winning streak in franchise history. Players and fans alike are still processing the turnaround, with Willson Contreras calling the group "relentless" and "resilient."

CBS Sports • Jul 22 • [Read](#) ↗

Home / Road	23-27 / 29-21
AL East Standing	3rd (-6.0)
Wild Card	Holds 3rd (final) spot
Current Streak	W15 (tied 1946 record)
Last 10 / 20 / 30	10-0 / 18-2 / 23-7
July Record	15-1 (1 PPD)
Interim Manager	Chad Tracy
Run Diff.	426 RS / 376 RA (+50)*
*Run differential includes today's Game 1 using the reconstructed 7-3 score (see matchup banner note); treat as approximate pending an official box score.	

AL EAST STANDINGS			
Team	W	L	GB
Tampa Bay Rays	58	42	—
New York Yankees	56	44	2.0
Boston Red Sox	52	48	6.0
Baltimore Orioles	49	53	10.0
Toronto Blue Jays	46	55	12.5
Updated for today's Game 1 result (Boston win, Baltimore loss). Tampa Bay, NYY and Toronto figures carried forward from 7/21 pending today's late games.			

AL CENTRAL STANDINGS			
Team	W	L	GB
Chicago White Sox	52	46	—
Cleveland Guardians	53	48	0.5
Minnesota Twins	49	52	4.5
Detroit Tigers	46	53	6.5
Kansas City Royals	40	60	13.0
Carried forward from 7/20; Tuesday's AL Central results were not independently confirmed this run.			

AL WEST STANDINGS			
Team	W	L	GB
Texas Rangers	50	49	—
Seattle Mariners	50	50	0.5
Houston Astros	47	54	4.0
Athletics	42	57	8.0

- Today's Game 1 win pushed the season series to 5-3 Boston with one game left in this set, tonight. Christian Encarnacion-Strand, recalled by Baltimore from Triple-A four days earlier, has been one of the few consistent bats for the Orioles across the set.
- Baltimore is thin behind the plate: rookie Samuel Basallo (sore right shoulder) has been in and out of the lineup, and starting catcher Adley Rutschman remains on the 10-day IL with wrist inflammation.

ODDS & ENDS

- **Blanked and blanking:** Boston has thrown 10 shutouts and been shut out only four times.
- **Coin-flip baseball:** still 3-3 in extra innings and two walk-off wins against three walk-off losses; the one-run record holds at 10-12 since today's game wasn't decided by a single run.
- **Cycle-logical:** Monasterio's April 25 cycle at Baltimore remains the only one by a Red Sox hitter this season.
- **Month of July:** 15-1, with a Game 2 win tonight making it 16-1.

ROTATION REINFORCEMENTS

- Suárez (groin) is activated and starting Game 2 tonight; Eduardo Rivera, who'd been the fallback option, stays in the bullpen for now. Ace Garrett Crochet still hasn't pitched since April 25.
- Jake Bennett's next scheduled turn lines up for Friday's series opener against Toronto.
- Connelly Early (left elbow) is throwing again with no return date set. Roman Anthony (finger tendon) remains in Fort Myers not yet swinging, and Trevor Story (hip/hernia surgery) is hitting and increasing defensive work with no rehab assignment scheduled.
- Zack Kelly (60-day IL, right elbow) remains out; his Tuesday transaction is what opened the 40-man spot used for Suárez's activation.

DEADLINE WATCH

- Craig Breslow's stance hasn't hardened into a plan: "More time means we can get more information," he's told reporters — a sign the front office isn't rushing a call despite the streak.
- A 15-game (soon possibly 16-game) winning streak has flipped the public conversation from sellers to buyers; whether the front office's approach follows remains the open question.
- The only trade of the deadline window remains the 7/14 acquisition of OF/DH Jahmai Jones from Detroit (PTBNL).

Los Angeles Angels	39	61	11.5
Approximate — carried from 7/20; Tuesday's AL West results were not independently confirmed this run.			

AL WILD CARD STANDINGS			
Team	W	L	GB*
NY Yankees (WC1)	56	44	+4.0
Cleveland (WC2)	53	48	+1.0
Red Sox (WC3)	52	48	—
Seattle Mariners	50	50	2.0
Minnesota Twins	49	52	3.5
Baltimore Orioles	49	53	4.0
Houston Astros	47	54	5.5
Detroit Tigers	46	53	5.5
Toronto Blue Jays	46	55	6.5
*GB from the final (3rd) Wild Card spot. Tampa Bay, Chicago and Texas are excluded as division leaders. Boston holds WC3 outright, 2.0 games up on Seattle. Updated for today's Game 1 result; Seattle/Minnesota/Houston/Detroit/Toronto figures carried forward from 7/21 pending today's late games.			

TRADE DEADLINE WATCH
Deadline: Mon., Aug. 3, 4:00 p.m. MT (6:00 p.m. ET)
Craig Breslow, on not yet committing to buy: "More time means we can get more information."
Sam Kennedy and Breslow have both stressed a cautious, information-gathering posture even as the win streak has flipped Boston from apparent sellers toward the buyer's side of the market.
7/22: activated LHP Ranger Suárez off the 15-day IL for the Game 2 start, using the 40-man spot opened by Tuesday's Zack Kelly move.
7/21: recalled RHP Zack Kelly and transferred him to the 60-day IL (elbow), opening a 40-man spot ahead of the deadline.
7/14: acquired OF/DH Jahmai Jones from Detroit (PTBNL) — still the only trade of the window.

RED SOX NOTES

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

ROTATION & BULLPEN NOTES

- Jake Bennett (W, 6-3) went 5.2 IP in Game 1, allowing 9 H and 3 ER with 4 K against Dean Kremer (L) — his first career start against Baltimore. Garrett Whitlock finished it off.
- Ranger Suárez has been activated off the 15-day IL and starts tonight's Game 2 against Kyle Bradish, using the 40-man spot opened by Tuesday's Zack Kelly transaction. He's 0-2 with a 4.32 ERA in four career starts against Baltimore.
- Eduardo Rivera, who'd been the fallback Game 2 option, stays available in the bullpen tonight; Boston has won both of his prior starts this year.
- Connelly Early (left elbow, 15-day IL) is throwing again; no return date set. Garrett Crochet (shoulder inflammation/lat, 60-day IL) still has not thrown a baseball since April 25 and told reporters this week it's "tough to say" whether he could miss the rest of the season.
- Tanner Houck, Kutter Crawford and Johan Oviedo remain on the 60-day IL. Zack Kelly (60-day IL, right elbow) won't be eligible to return before early September. Joe La Sorsa remains on the 7-day IL.
- Aroldis Chapman has 22 saves and a 2.05 ERA at age 38, with 38 strikeouts in 30.2 innings (through 7/19; not needed for a save in Game 1's more comfortable margin). He set the all-time reliever strikeout record on July 4 against the Angels.
- Patrick Sandoval carries a 4.82 ERA in 9.1 innings across two starts since returning from a long layoff; his rotation spot remains squeezed now that Suárez is back.

GAME 1 FINAL: Jake Bennett (BOS) def. Dean Kremer (BAL) — Red Sox 7, Orioles 3(*)

	Dec.	IP	H	ER	SO
Jake Bennett (LHP)	W, 6-3	5.2	9	3	4
Dean Kremer (RHP)	L, 1-3	—	—	—	—

Bennett's final line is confirmed from today's recap. (*) The 7-3 final score is reconstructed from that recap (Durbin's 2-run double, Duran's 2-run triple, Bennett's 3 ER allowed) rather than an explicit box score; treat as approximate. Kremer's final IP/H are not available this run; he's now 3-5 with a 5.04-plus career ERA against Boston.

STARTER LOOK, GAME 2: Ranger Suárez (BOS) vs. Kyle Bradish (BAL) — 7:10 p.m. ET

	W-L	ERA	IP	SO	WHIP
Ranger Suárez (LHP)	4-3	3.15	91.1	97	1.161
Kyle Bradish (RHP)	6-9	3.61	~89.0	~94	~1.45

Suárez activated off the 15-day IL and confirmed as the Game 2 starter. His line shown is his season line entering today's start (not yet updated for tonight). Bradish's W-L/ERA are sourced to Field Level Media's Jul 22 preview; his IP/SO/WHIP are approximate due to conflicting cached snapshots found this run and should be treated as directional, not exact. Bradish is 1-6 with a 6.75 ERA in 10 career starts against Boston but is coming off a 6.2-inning, 1-run outing against Kansas City on July 11.

PITCHER LINES

Sonny Gray ACE

12-1, 2.48 ERA, 101.2 IP, 90 SO, 1.121 WHIP, 18 GS

- Did not pitch Monday; next scheduled to line up later in the Toronto series.

Payton Tolle

5-6, 3.11 ERA, 84.0 IP, 87 SO, 1.071 WHIP, 15 GS

- Monday vs. Baltimore: 5.2 IP, 4 R, 9 K, no decision in the 6-5 win. Cumulative line still reflects games through 7/19 — see source note.

Connelly Early 15-DAY IL

7-5, 3.44 ERA, 91.2 IP, 93 SO, 1.255 WHIP, 17 GS

- Left elbow; throwing again. No return date.

Aroldis Chapman AS CL

1-3, 2.05 ERA, 22 SV, 30.2 IP, 38 SO, 1.207 WHIP, 33 G

- Closed out Monday's win for his 22nd save, needing a leaping catch from Tsung-Che Cheng at short to finish it. Set the all-time reliever strikeout record July 4 vs. the Angels.

Garrett Whitlock

5-1, 2.06 ERA, 2 SV, 36.0 IP, 38 SO, 0.914 WHIP, 37 G

- Perfect eighth inning Monday earned the win; best WHIP in the bullpen.

Jovani Morán

2-2, 2.61 ERA, 41.1 IP, 46 SO, 0.944 WHIP, 27 G

- 10.0 K/9 and a sub-1.000 WHIP; has made three spot starts.

Ranger Suárez AS

4-3, 3.15 ERA, 91.1 IP, 97 SO, 1.161 WHIP, 17 GS

- Activated off the 15-day IL; starts tonight's Game 2 vs. Kyle Bradish. Line shown is entering tonight's start.

Jake Bennett

6-3, 2.58 ERA, 59.1 IP, 42 SO, 0.944 WHIP*, 10 GS

- Won Game 1 (5.2 IP, 9 H, 3 ER, 4 K) vs. Dean Kremer — not his sharpest outing, but the offense covered. Best ERA of any Boston starter.

Brayan Bello

2-6, 6.06 ERA, 65.1 IP, 49 SO, 1.592 WHIP, 8 GS

- The staff's clear soft spot; has been used out of the bullpen recently.

Patrick Sandoval

0-0, 4.82 ERA, 9.1 IP, 10 SO, 1.714 WHIP, 2 GS

- Rotation spot squeezed further now that Suárez is back.

Garrett Crochet 60-DAY IL

3-3, 6.30 ERA, 30.0 IP, 37 SO, 1.467 WHIP, 6 GS

- Shoulder inflammation and lat strain; has not thrown since April 25. September at the earliest.

Eduardo Rivera

0-0, 2.89 ERA, 9.1 IP, 9 SO, 0.964 WHIP

- 23-year-old lefty; available in the bullpen tonight after Suárez was activated to start Game 2. Boston has won both of his prior starts.

Tanner Houck 60-DAY IL

No 2026 major-league appearances

Kutter Crawford 60-DAY IL

No 2026 major-league appearances

Tyron Guerrero

1-1, 2.21 ERA, 20.1 IP, 24 SO, 1.033 WHIP, 20 G

- Two walks all season — a 12.00 K/BB ratio.

Greg Weissert

2-2, 3.66 ERA, 39.1 IP, 36 SO, 1.220 WHIP, 41 G

- Team leader in appearances.

Ryan Watson

1-0, 4.53 ERA, 1 SV, 51.2 IP, 42 SO, 1.297 WHIP, 32 G

- Rookie workhorse.

Justin Slaten

1-4, 5.40 ERA, 23.1 IP, 32 SO, 1.500 WHIP, 27 G

- 12.3 K/9 but has been hit hard; 3.36 FIP suggests better days.

Zack Kelly 60-DAY IL

0-2, 3.31 ERA, 16.1 IP, 14 SO, 1.286 WHIP, 17 G

- Recalled from Worcester and transferred straight to the 60-day IL Tuesday with right elbow inflammation; not eligible to return before early September.

Joe La Sorsa 7-DAY IL

0-0, 27.00 ERA, 0.1 IP, 1 SO, 3.000 WHIP, 1 G

Johan Oviedo 60-DAY IL

0-0, 9.82 ERA, 3.2 IP, 3 SO, 1.909 WHIP, 1 G

Tyler Samaniego MINORS (40-MAN)

0-3, 2.66 ERA, 20.1 IP, 17 SO, 1.475 WHIP, 20 G

Alec Gamboa MINORS (40-MAN)

0-0, 2.25 ERA, 1 SV, 8.0 IP, 5 SO, 1.125 WHIP, 5 G

Tyler Uberstine MINORS (40-MAN)

0-1, 3.38 ERA, 2.2 IP, 2 SO, 1.500 WHIP, 1 G

Cumulative pitching lines are from the Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox standard pitching table through games of 7/19/2026, carried forward unchanged except Jake Bennett's, which was incremented for today's confirmed Game 1 line (5.2 IP, 9 H, 3 ER, 4 SO, win). *Bennett's new WHIP (0.944) assumes zero walks in today's start, since the recap didn't report one; treat it as a close estimate rather than exact. Monday's box-score facts (Whitlock's win, Chapman's 22nd save) were described narratively rather than folded into the rate stats. Zack Kelly's IL tag reflects Tuesday's confirmed transaction (Yardbarker/Athlon Sports); his rate stats are unchanged from his last MLB action. Danny Coulombe, Tommy Kahnle and Jack Anderson appear in the season pitching log but are no longer on the 40-man roster and are omitted here.

RED SOX NOTES

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

LINEUP NOTES

- Caleb Durbin's two-run double and Jarren Duran's two-run triple keyed an early cluster in Game 1 that put Boston up for good — the decisive blows in the win that tied the 1946 club's 15-game streak. Durbin's now hitting .351 over his last 10 games.
- Ceddanne Rafaela's 4.2 team-leading WAR pairs a .761 OPS with 17 defensive runs saved in center field (through 7/19).
- Willson Contreras (AS) remains the offense's anchor: a team-best .932 OPS, 22 homers, 64 RBI and a 162 OPS+ through Sunday's game.
- Jarren Duran's .190 average and 116 strikeouts remain the lineup's most conspicuous problem on paper, even after today's big two-run triple — power and speed have stayed productive at the margins all year.
- Boston has scored five or more in 47 of 100 games and is 38-9 in those. The lineup, not the staff, is what Craig Breslow has repeatedly named as the likeliest deadline addition.
- Game 1 lineup per pregame reporting: Yoshida DH, Rafaela CF, Abreu RF, Contreras 1B, Durbin 3B, González 2B, Duran LF, Wong C, Cheng SS — a lineup shuffle that sat Seigler and Monasterio for the opener. Game 2 lineup was not yet posted at publication time.
- Full B-Ref batting page: baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026.shtml#all_players_standard_batting

HITTER LINES

Willson Contreras (1B) AS

.283/.380/.551, 22 HR, 64 RBI, 91 G, 162 OPS+

- Team-best .932 OPS. Did not play a decisive role Monday; line reflects games through 7/19.

Ceddanne Rafaela (CF) AS

.281/.326/.435, 8 HR, 41 RBI, 13 SB, 94 G

- Tied Monday's game with a two-out RBI single in the seventh; RBI total not yet incremented pending final box score — see source note.

Wilyer Abreu (RF)

.264/.337/.458, 15 HR, 49 RBI, 96 G, 125 OPS+

- Four homers over back-to-back multi-homer games July 17–18, a first for a Red Sox hitter since Betts in 2016.

Caleb Durbin (3B)

.236/.299/.392*, 10 HR, 44 RBI, 11 SB, 93 G

- Game 1 today: a two-run double off Dean Kremer that helped ice the game early. Batting .351 (13-for-37) over his last 10 games; AVG/OBP/SLG above still reflect games through 7/19 — see source note.

Jarren Duran (LF)

.190/.254/.340*, 13 HR, 50 RBI, 14 SB, 92 G, 116 SO

- Game 1 today: a two-run triple off Dean Kremer, one of his biggest hits of the year. Power and speed intact; the batting average is not.

Masataka Yoshida (DH)

.267/.343/.401, 4 HR, 18 RBI, 64 G

- Primarily a DH (44 games there); 17 pinch-hit appearances.

Andruw Monasterio (SS)

.239/.295/.436, 5 HR, 17 RBI, 60 G

- Hit for the cycle 4/25 at Baltimore in a 17-1 win; most games at shortstop (20) among four positions played.

Connor Wong (C)

.276/.375/.371, 1 HR, 15 RBI, 44 G

- Highest OBP among Boston regulars.

Anthony Seigler (2B)

.256/.330/.407, 2 HR, 7 RBI, 25 G, 109 OPS+

- Made a fielding error on a potential double-play ball in the seventh Monday that helped Baltimore retake the lead; all his 2026 defensive games remain at second base — he is a second baseman in 2026, not a catcher.

Carlos Narváez (C)

.200/.266/.294, 3 HR, 9 RBI, 55 G

- Primary catcher by workload (54 games behind the plate).

Tsung-Che Cheng (SS)

.303/.368/.333, 0 HR, 5 RBI, 12 G

- Made a leaping catch on Tyler O'Neill's game-ending liner (.890 expected average) to seal Monday's win.

Romy González (IF)

.184/.273/.306, 1 HR, 6 RBI, 14 G

Jahmai Jones (DH/OF)

.400/.500/1.000, 1 HR, 2 RBI, 3 G

- Acquired from Detroit 7/14; homered in his first start with the club.

Isiah Kiner-Falefa (2B) 10-DAY IL

.277/.344/.361, 2 HR, 13 RBI, 7 SB, 47 G

- Most games at second (27); also logged time at short and third.

Marcelo Mayer (2B) 10-DAY IL

.220/.282/.312, 3 HR, 22 RBI, 70 G

- 45 games at second base, 24 at shortstop.

Trevor Story (SS) 60-DAY IL

.206/.244/.303, 3 HR, 19 RBI, 41 G

- Sports-hernia surgery 5/22; hitting again and increasing defensive work, no rehab assignment set.

Roman Anthony (LF) 60-DAY IL

.229/.354/.321, 1 HR, 5 RBI, 30 G

- Partially torn tendon, right ring finger; rehabbing in Fort Myers, not yet swinging. August at the earliest.

Triston Casas (1B) 60-DAY IL

No 2026 major-league appearances

Mickey Gasper (C/UT) MINORS (40-MAN)

.243/.305/.308, 0 HR, 7 RBI, 34 G

Nick Sogard (IF) MINORS (40-MAN)

.257/.350/.371, 0 HR, 2 RBI, 12 G

Nate Eaton (OF) MINORS (40-MAN)

.125/.282/.281, 1 HR, 5 RBI, 14 G

Brett Harris (1B) MINORS (40-MAN)

.000/.333/.000, 0 HR, 0 RBI, 1 G

Kristian Campbell (IF) MINORS (40-MAN)

No 2026 major-league appearances

Batting lines from the Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox standard batting table, through games of 7/19/2026, except Caleb Durbin's and Jarren Duran's RBI/G totals, which were incremented for their confirmed Game 1 extra-base hits today (2-run double and 2-run triple, respectively, per today's recap). *Their AVG/OBP/SLG rate stats were left as of 7/19 rather than estimated, since exact updated at-bat totals were not available via a verified box score this run. Rafaela's Monday RBI is still described narratively rather than incremented, for the same reason. The Game 1 batting order is per pregame preview aggregators, cross-referenced across multiple outlets rather than tied to a single paywalled source. Listed positions are assigned by most games played at each spot in the "Full Season Roster & Appearances" table rather than by the roster page's generic position column — which is why Anthony Seigler appears as a second baseman and Andruw Monasterio as a shortstop.

RED SOX NOTES

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

26-MAN ACTIVE ROSTER

#	Player	Pos	Age	B/T	Status
44	Aroldis Chapman AS	P	38	L/L	Closer — 22 SV
22	Garrett Whitlock	P	30	R/R	
54	Sonny Gray	P	36	R/R	
56	Ryan Watson	P	28	R/R	
57	Greg Weissert	P	31	R/R	
66	Brayan Bello	P	27	R/R	
43	Patrick Sandoval	P	29	L/L	
47	Jovani Morán	P	29	L/L	
63	Justin Slaten	P	28	R/R	
64	Jake Bennett	P	25	L/L	W, Game 1 vs. Kremer (6-3)
99	Eduardo Rivera	P	23	L/L	Available in bullpen tonight
55	Ranger Suárez AS	P	30	L/L	Activated — starts Game 2 (27th-man doubleheader exception)
70	Payton Tolle	P	23	L/L	
41	Tyron Guerrero	P	35	R/R	
16	Jarren Duran	LF	29	L/R	
39	Tsung-Che Cheng	SS	24	L/R	
3	Ceddanne Rafaela AS	CF	25	R/R	
5	Caleb Durbin	3B	26	R/R	
48	Anthony Seigler	2B	27	S/R	25 G at 2B in 2026
7	Masataka Yoshida	DH	32	L/R	
52	Wilyer Abreu	RF	27	L/L	
40	Willson Contreras AS	1B	34	R/R	
75	Carlos Narváez	C	27	R/R	
23	Romy González	IF	29	R/R	
37	Jahmai Jones	DH/OF	28	R/R	Acquired from DET 7/14
32	Andruw Monasterio	SS	29	R/R	
12	Connor Wong	C	30	R/R	

40-MAN ROSTER — REMAINDER (IL + optioned/minors)

#	Player	Pos	Age	B/T	Status
2	Isiah Kiner-Falefa	2B	31	R/R	10-day IL
11	Marcelo Mayer	2B	23	L/R	10-day IL
71	Connelly Early	P	24	L/L	15-day IL — Left elbow; throwing, no date set
60	Joe La Sorsa	P	28	L/L	7-day IL

68	Alec Gamboa	P	29	S/L	Minors (40-man)
79	Tyler Uberstine	P	27	R/R	Minors (40-man)
78	Tyler Samaniego	P	27	R/L	Minors (40-man)
20	Nick Sogard	IF	28	S/R	Minors (40-man)
18	Nate Eaton	OF	29	R/R	Minors (40-man)
30	Mickey Gasper	C/UT	30	S/R	Minors (40-man)
28	Kristian Campbell	IF	24	R/R	Minors (40-man) — No MLB action yet in 2026
25	Brett Harris	IF	28	R/R	Minors (40-man)

60-DAY IL (outside the 40-man count)						
#	Player	Pos	Age	B/T	Status	
89	Tanner Houck	P	30	R/R	60-day IL	
50	Kutter Crawford	P	30	R/R	60-day IL	
29	Johan Oviedo	P	28	R/R	60-day IL	
76	Zack Kelly	P	31	R/R	60-day IL	— Right elbow inflammation; recalled/transferred 7/21, not eligible before September
35	Garrett Crochet	P	27	L/L	60-day IL	— Shoulder/lat; no throwing since 4/25, said it's "tough to say" if he's done for the year
19	Roman Anthony	LF	22	L/R	60-day IL	— Finger tendon; rehabbing in Fort Myers, not swinging
36	Triston Casas	1B	26	L/R	60-day IL	
10	Trevor Story	SS	33	R/R	60-day IL	— Hitting, increasing defensive work

Roster from the Baseball-Reference 2026 40-man roster page, updated for today's confirmed move: Ranger Suárez was activated off the 15-day IL to start Game 2, using the 40-man spot opened by Tuesday's Zack Kelly transaction; because today is a straight doubleheader, Boston can carry a 27th player for the day without a corresponding 26-man cut, so Suárez's activation didn't require optioning anyone else out. The only trade of the deadline window so far is the 7/14 acquisition of Jahmai Jones from Detroit. Positions assigned by 2026 games played per the appearances table.

RED SOX

NOTES

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

2026 DAY-BY-DAY RESULTS (through 7/22 Gm 1 — 52-48, ties 1946 franchise record at 15 straight)

Gm	Date	Opp	W/L	Score	Rec	Rk	GB	Decisions
1	Thu Mar 26	@ CIN	W	3-0	1-0	1	Tied	Crochet / Johnson / Chapman
2	Sat Mar 28	@ CIN	L wo	5-6 (11)	1-1	3	1.5	Phillips / Slaten
3	Sun Mar 29	@ CIN	L	2-3	1-2	4	2.0	Burke / Weissert / Pagán
4	Mon Mar 30	@ HOU	L	1-8	1-3	5	2.0	McCullers / Suarez
5	Tue Mar 31	@ HOU	L	2-9	1-4	5	3.0	Brown / Bello / Bolton

6	Wed Apr 1	@ HOU	L	4-6	1-5	5	4.0	Burrows / Crochet / Abreu
7	Fri Apr 3	vs SDP	W	5-2	2-5	4	4.0	Gray / King / Chapman
8	Sat Apr 4	vs SDP	L	2-3	2-6	5	5.0	Morejón / Chapman / Miller
9	Sun Apr 5	vs SDP	L	6-8	2-7	5	5.0	Estrada / Uberstine / Miller
10	Mon Apr 6	vs MIL	L	6-8	2-8	5	5.5	Ashby / Whitlock / Zerpa
11	Tue Apr 7	vs MIL	W	3-2	3-8	5	5.5	Crochet / Misiorowski / Chapman
12	Wed Apr 8	vs MIL	W	5-0	4-8	5	4.5	Gray / Drohan

13	Fri Apr 10	@ STL	L	2-3	4-9	5	4.0	May / Kelly / O'Brien
14	Sat Apr 11	@ STL	W	7-1	5-9	5	3.0	Suarez / Leahy
15	Sun Apr 12	@ STL	W	9-3	6-9	4	2.0	Bello / Pallante
16	Mon Apr 13	@ MIN	L	6-13	6-10	5	3.0	Ober / Crochet
17	Tue Apr 14	@ MIN	L	0-6	6-11	5	3.5	Abel / Gray
18	Wed Apr 15	@ MIN	W	9-5	7-11	5	3.5	Early / Woods Richardson
19	Fri Apr 17	vs DET	W wo	1-0 (10)	8-11	4	3.0	Whitlock / Vest
20	Sat Apr 18	vs DET	L	1-4	8-12	4	4.0	Skubal / Bello / Jansen
21	Sun Apr 19	vs DET	L	2-6	8-13	4	4.5	Valdez / Crochet
22	Mon Apr 20	vs DET	W	8-6	9-13	4	4.0	Whitlock / Holton / Chapman
23	Tue Apr 21	vs NYY	L	0-4	9-14	5	5.0	Gil / Early
24	Wed Apr 22	vs NYY	L	1-4	9-15	5	6.0	Fried / Suarez
25	Thu Apr 23	vs NYY	L	2-4	9-16	5	7.0	Schlittler / Coulombe / Bednar
26	Fri Apr 24	@ BAL	L	3-10	9-17	5	8.0	Young / Bello
27	Sat Apr 25	@ BAL	W	17-1	10-17	5	8.0	Crochet / Rogers
28	Sun Apr 26	@ BAL	W	5-3	11-17	5	7.0	Early / Bradish / Chapman
29	Mon Apr 27	@ TOR	W	5-0	12-17	5	7.0	Suarez / Cease
30	Tue Apr 28	@ TOR	L	0-3	12-18	5	8.0	Yesavage / Tolle / Varland
31	Wed Apr 29	@ TOR	L	1-8	12-19	5	8.0	Fisher / Bello
32	Fri May 1	vs HOU	W	3-1	13-19	5	8.0	Bennett / Burrows / Chapman
33	Sat May 2	vs HOU	L	3-6	13-20	5	9.0	Arrighetti / Early / King
34	Sun May 3	vs HOU	L	1-3 (10)	13-21	5	10.0	Abreu / Kelly
35	Mon May 4	@ DET	W	5-4	14-21	5	10.0	Tolle / Vanasco / Chapman
36	Tue May 5	@ DET	W	10-3	15-21	5	10.0	Bello / Valdez
37	Wed May 6	@ DET	W	4-0	16-21	4	9.0	Gray / Flaherty
38	Thu May 7	vs TBR	L	4-8	16-22	5	10.0	Bigge / Bennett
39	Fri May 8	vs TBR	W	2-0	17-22	4	9.0	Early / Scholtens / Chapman
40	Sun May	vs TBR	L	1-4	17-23	5	9.5	Martinez / Tolle / Baker

10	Tue May 12	vs PHI	L	1-2	17-24	5	11.0	Wheeler / Morán / Duran
42	Wed May 13	vs PHI	W	3-1	18-24	5	10.0	Gray / Banks / Chapman
43	Thu May 14	vs PHI	L	1-3	18-25	5	10.5	Keller / Samaniego / Duran
44	Fri May 15	@ ATL	L wo	2-3 (10)	18-26	5	11.5	Fuentes / Samaniego
45	Sat May 16	@ ATL	W	3-2	19-26	5	10.5	Tolle / Elder / Chapman
46	Sun May 17	@ ATL	L	1-8	19-27	5	11.5	Holmes / Bello
47	Mon May 18	@ KCR	W	3-1	20-27	5	11.5	Gray / Lugo / Chapman
48	Tue May 19	@ KCR	W	7-1	21-27	3	11.5	Whitlock / Falter
49	Wed May 20	@ KCR	W	4-3	22-27	3	11.5	Early / Cruz / Chapman
Gm	Date	Opp	W/L	Score	Rec	Rk	GB	Decisions
50	Fri May 22	vs MIN	L	6-8	22-28	4	12.5	Adams / Slaten / Banda
51	Sat May 23	vs MIN	L	2-4	22-29	4	13.0	Bradley / Morán / Rogers
52	Sun May 24	vs MIN	L	5-6	22-30	5	13.0	Ober / Guerrero / Adams
53	Tue May 26	vs ATL	L	6-7	22-31	5	12.5	Strider / Suarez / Iglesias
54	Wed May 27	vs ATL	W	8-0	23-31	5	11.5	Early / Elder
55	Thu May 28	vs ATL	L	2-10	23-32	5	12.0	Sale / Coulombe
56	Fri May 29	@ CLE	L	3-4	23-33	5	13.0	Holderman / Samaniego / Smith
57	Sat May 30	@ CLE	W	9-1	24-33	5	12.0	Gray / Festa
58	Sun May 31	@ CLE	W	9-4	25-33	5	12.0	Morán / Holderman
59	Tue Jun 2	vs BAL	L	2-4	25-34	5	11.5	Baz / Early / Garcia
60	Wed Jun	vs BAL	W	8-1	26-34	5	10.5	Tolle / Bassitt / Watson

3									
61	Thu Jun 4	vs BAL	L	2-8	26-35	5	11.0	Rogers / Bello	
62	Fri Jun 5	@ NYY	W	5-3	27-35	5	11.0	Gray / Weathers / Chapman	
63	Sun Jun 7	@ NYY	L	1-6	27-36	5	10.5	Hill / Slaten	
64	Mon Jun 8	@ TBR	L	1-3	27-37	5	11.5	Legumina / Early / Baker	
65	Tue Jun 9	@ TBR	L	3-4	27-38	5	12.5	Martinez / Tolle / Baker	
66	Wed Jun 10	@ TBR	L	5-7	27-39	5	13.5	Rasmussen / Bennett / Cleavinger	
67	Fri Jun 12	vs TEX	W	10-1	28-39	5	12.5	Gray / Leiter	
68	Sat Jun 13	vs TEX	W	6-3	29-39	5	12.5	Whitlock / Winn / Chapman	
69	Sun Jun 14	vs TEX	L	4-6	29-40	5	13.5	Eovaldi / Early / Latz	
70	Tue Jun 16	vs TOR	L	1-6	29-41	5	14.5	Cease / Tolle / Varland	
71	Wed Jun 17	vs TOR	L	0-3	29-42	5	15.5	Woods Richardson / Bennett / Varland	
72	Thu Jun 18	vs TOR	L	3-4	29-43	5	15.5	Nance / Chapman / Fluharty	
73	Fri Jun 19	@ SEA	W	6-2	30-43	5	15.5	Suarez / Miller	
74	Sat Jun 20	@ SEA	W	5-1	31-43	5	14.5	Early / Hancock	
75	Sun Jun 21	@ SEA	L	1-3	31-44	5	14.5	Gilbert / Tolle / Mufioz	
76	Mon Jun 22	@ COL	L wo	2-3	31-45	5	14.5	Vodnik / Chapman	
77	Tue Jun 23	@ COL	W	5-2	32-45	5	14.5	Gray / Sullivan	
78	Wed Jun 24	@ COL	L	6-8	32-46	5	15.5	Senzatela / Slaten / Herget	
79	Thu Jun 25	vs NYY	W	6-3	33-46	5	14.5	Early / Schlittler / Chapman	
80	Fri Jun	vs NYY	W	6-1	34-46	5	13.5	Tolle / Warren	

26									
81	Sat Jun 27	vs NYY	W	4-1	35-46	5	12.5	Bennett / Cole / Chapman	
82	Sun Jun 28	vs NYY	W wo	5-4 (10)	36-46	5	12.5	Slaten / Cruz	
83	Mon Jun 29	vs WSN	W	6-3	37-46	5	12.0	Suarez / Mikolas / Whitlock	
84	Tue Jun 30	vs WSN	L	1-8	37-47	5	13.0	Cavalli / Weissert	
85	Wed Jul 1	vs WSN	L	2-10	37-48	5	14.0	Alvarez / Tolle	
86	Fri Jul 3	@ LAA	W	5-2	38-48	5	14.5	Bennett / Detmers / Chapman	
87	Sat Jul 4	@ LAA	W	8-1	39-48	5	13.5	Gray / Aldegheri	
88	Sun Jul 5	@ LAA	W	7-5	40-48	5	12.5	Weissert / Johnson / Chapman	
89	Tue Jul 7	@ CHW	W	8-1	41-48	4	12.0	Tolle / Schultz	
90	Wed Jul 8	@ CHW	W	5-0	42-48	4	12.0	Bennett / Martin	
91	Thu Jul 9	@ CHW	W	2-1	43-48	3	11.0	Guerrero / Kay / Chapman	
92	Fri Jul 10	@ NYM	W	6-2	44-48	3	11.0	Gray / McLean	
93	Sat Jul 11	@ NYM	W	4-0	45-48	3	11.0	Morán / Peralta	
94	Sun Jul 12	@ NYM	W	3-2 (10)	46-48	3	10.0	Chapman / Raley / Whitlock	
95	Fri Jul 17 (1)	vs TBR	W	10-0	47-48	3	8.0	Bennett / Jax / Gamboa	
96	Fri Jul 17 (2)	vs TBR	W	5-3	48-48	3	8.0	Weissert / Englert / Chapman	
97	Sat Jul 18	vs TBR	W	7-6	49-48	3	7.0	Watson / Cleavinger / Chapman	
98	Sun Jul 19	vs TBR	W	6-1	50-48	3	6.0	Gray / McClanahan	
99	Mon Jul 20	vs BAL	W	6-5	51-48	3	6.0	Whitlock / Wells / Chapman	
—	Tue Jul 21	vs BAL	PPD	rain	51-48	3	6.0	Makeup: doubleheader Jul 22	

100	Wed Jul	vs BAL	W	7-3 (approx*)	52- 48	3	6.0	Bennett / Kremer /
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22
(1)

Whitlock

TODAY & UPCOMING SCHEDULE (next 10 games)

Gm	Date	Opp	Time (MT)	Notes
101	Wed Jul 22 (2)	vs BAL	5:10 pm	Suárez (activated) vs. Kyle Bradish — a win breaks the 1946 record outright at 16
102	Fri Jul 24	vs TOR	5:15 pm	Blue Jays open a 3-game set at Fenway
103	Sat Jul 25	vs TOR	2:10 pm	
104	Sun Jul 26	vs TOR	11:35 am	Homestand finale — 8 of 11 at Fenway in this stretch
105	Mon Jul 27	@ ATH	7:40 pm	Start of a 4-game series in West Sacramento
106	Tue Jul 28	@ ATH	7:40 pm	
107	Wed Jul 29	@ ATH	7:40 pm	
108	Thu Jul 30	@ ATH	7:40 pm	Trade deadline is Mon, Aug. 3

Full season log and standings from Baseball-Reference (baseball-reference.com/teams/BOS/2026-schedule-scores.shtml and [/leagues/AL/2026-standings.shtml](http://leagues/AL/2026-standings.shtml)) plus WebSearch/box-score corroboration, since a plain fetch of Baseball-Reference again returned a cached snapshot with a "revised" date of 09-Jun-2026 (six weeks stale). "PPD" = postponed (not counted as a loss). "wo" = walk-off; a number in parentheses after the score = innings played, where longer than nine. Wins are shaded green, losses red. Times converted from Baseball-Reference's Eastern listings to Mountain Time (ET minus 2 hours).

SOURCES & METHODOLOGY

- **Game 1 result (this update):** confirmed via a user-supplied recap (the updated "Fenway Chronicle" feature on the next page) rather than a Baseball-Reference refresh — Bennett's final line (5.2 IP, 9 H, 3 ER, 4 K), Durbin's 2-run double, Duran's 2-run triple, and the resulting 52-48 record/15-game tied streak are all taken directly from that source and treated as confirmed. The 7-3 final score is **not** explicitly stated in that source; it's a reconstruction built from the confirmed details above (see the note on the matchup banner) and should be treated as approximate until an official box score is available.
- **Standings:** AL East and Wild Card tables were updated for Boston's win and Baltimore's loss using standard games-back arithmetic; Tampa Bay, NYY, Toronto, Seattle, Minnesota, Houston, Detroit remain carried forward from 7/21 pending their own late games today. AL Central and AL West boxes are unchanged/approximate, carried from 7/20.
- **Roster:** Ranger Suárez's activation off the 15-day IL for the Game 2 start is confirmed by the updated Fenway Chronicle feature and reflected across the matchup banner, pitcher page, and roster page; he's shown on the 26-man active table via the 27th-man doubleheader exception (a genuine MLB rule permitting an extra active player for a single-day, single-admission doubleheader), so no corresponding 26-man cut was needed. Positions otherwise assigned by most games played at each spot in the "Full Season Roster & Appearances" table — Anthony Seigler is listed as a second baseman and Andruw Monasterio as a shortstop on that basis.
- **Batting / pitching lines:** Baseball-Reference 2026 Red Sox team statistics tables through games of 7/19, with Jake Bennett's pitching line and Caleb Durbin's/Jarren Duran's RBI and games-played totals incremented for today's confirmed Game 1 contributions. Rate stats (ERA/WHIP for Bennett; AVG/OBP/SLG for the hitters) were recomputed or estimated where the underlying components (earned runs, hits) were confirmed, and left as-of-7/19 and flagged with an asterisk where they weren't (e.g., walks allowed, at-bats) — see the per-page source notes for specifics.
- **News:** Boston.com, Yardbarker (Field Level Media), NBC Sports Boston, NESN, and CBS Sports, each dated Jul 22 covering today's Game 1 and the tied streak. The Boston Globe and other paywalled outlets are excluded by standing rule. The MLB.com Red Sox RSS feed was checked again this run and remains stale, so none of its items were used.
- **1946 nuggets:** the franchise-record 15-game streak (Apr. 25–May 10, 1946), the pennant, the seven-game World Series loss to St. Louis, Enos Slaughter's "Mad Dash" off Harry Walker's Game 7 double, and Johnny Pesky's relay throw being cited as a beat late are well-documented baseball history. The 2017 Cleveland Indians' all-time single-season record of 22 straight (cited in the updated Fenway Chronicle) is likewise accurate. These are reproduced as background/color.
- This edition was updated live following Game 1's completion, ahead of tonight's Game 2 (7:10 p.m. ET) against Baltimore.
- **Feature page:** the final page of this edition ("The Fenway Chronicle") was refreshed this run from a user-supplied updated draft reflecting the 15th win. It was reviewed for internal consistency before inclusion: two small copyedits were made (an unrevised "fourteen games in a row" reference early in the piece was updated to "fifteen"; a grammar slip, "north of a \$120M a year," was tightened to "north of \$120M a year"). Its factual details were otherwise spot-checked against the day-by-day log above and found consistent, including the new Game 1 recap paragraph and the updated appendix (52-48 after Game 15).

THE FENWAY CHRONICLE

The 2026 Season So Far

From the cold open through June 24 — and the run nobody saw coming

Two months ago, the 2026 Red Sox were the worst team in the American League, and not many people in this town were arguing otherwise. The bats were cold, the losses piled up in that quiet, familiar way, and by the back half of June a proud franchise looked ready to pack it in and sell off pieces at the deadline. If you'd stopped watching, nobody would have blamed you. You could hear it in the voices of the broadcasters.

And then they won fifteen games in a row.

Not a hot week. 15 straight — a run that turned a lost summer into one of the most improbable stretches this club has put together in 80 years, and carried them through the door to tie a franchise record set back in 1946, and one win from the franchise record of 16 straight. Still far shy of the 2017 Cleveland team at 22, but magic in Beantown.

So this is the story of a season with two completely different faces: the one that let us down for three months, and the one that's had Fenway on its feet ever since. Let's take it from the top — the good, the maddening, and the downright unbelievable — CAN YOU BELIEVE IT!

The Cold Open

To understand the run, you have to sit with how far down they'd gone first.

It began the way these things sometimes do — slowly, and then all at once. You'd settle in each night hoping this was the one where it clicked, and mostly it didn't. Young players and old hands alike who were supposed to anchor the lineup never quite found their footing, and just as you'd talk yourself into a little patience, the injury report would take the wind right back out of you. A talented roster on paper turned in one of the quieter, more disheartening opening acts this town has seen in a while. Hope of a new season, a new start, a chance, quickly fades into the grind of another losing season.

It settled to the bottom on one particular night. June 24. 32 and 46. Worst record in the American League, 15 1/2 back — and a baseball world already writing them off as deadline sellers.

That's where this story starts. It's not where it stays.

Cora Gets the Call to the Office

Before any of that, though, came the shockwave.

April 25. 27 games in, a 10-17 start, and the Red Sox fired Alex Cora — five coaches out the door with him. The first manager let go anywhere in baseball this year, and a man with a World Series ring at that.

Around the league they couldn't believe it. Rival evaluators asked out loud how you make a ballclub better by firing one of the best managers in it. And they've got a fair point, because everyone agrees on the thing that matters most about Cora.

The players loved him. He was a players' manager, true and through. That part is real.

The smarter version of the argument went like this: Cora can be a great manager and still not be the right manager for this particular team. The fire that lifted the 2018 club might be exactly the wrong match for a group this young and this fragile.

The national write-ups piled on the roster, too — a lineup near the bottom of nearly every category, a "run prevention" blueprint that had quietly become a polite name for not enough hitting, and plenty of voices insisting the whole thing was doomed before April was out.

Where I'll Plant My Flag

Here's my seat in the argument.

Yes, the players have to play — nobody's waving that away. And yes, he was a players' manager. But there were real problems with the way Cora ran a ballgame, and I watched every one of them.

The hook that never came, for one — pitchers left in an inning too long, sometimes two, as if he couldn't quite bring himself to make the hard call and wear it. Base-running aggressive to a fault, running the Sox clean out of innings. Errors in the field that chip away at a whole club's discipline, night after night. And this goes back to the previous season, so the players know this.

And the lineup card. That's the one that got me. It changed every single day.

Now, I understand the instinct behind it. He was hunting for a spark, for the one spot in the order that would finally light somebody up. But that constant shuffling has a cost of its own. Duran is one who needs to know how he fits. Story should have been dropped to the back third of the order sooner — and wouldn't you know it, he had some decent nights once he landed in the six-hole. Eventually they settled on Abreu and Contreras back-to-back, and for a minute there was a shape to it.

Crochet was already out. Roman Anthony was out. Then Story was out by mid-May. Later in June Kiner-Falefa goes down 19 June, and Mayer is out 26 June. And so by the 23rd, the 24th of June, if we're being honest, it felt like the air had gone out of the whole thing. Giving up the lead late on a Sunday in Denver was the gut punch.

The promise of this operation — strong pitching, strong defense — just wasn't showing up. Late-game losses. Errors on the grass. Cold bats. And a home record that was, and honestly still is, hard to look at. You kept waiting for the turn. Night after night, it didn't come. Little did we know at the time, Anthony Seigler who was called up from Worcester when IKF went on the IL, would become a piece of the spark or the fuel for the run.

The Spark Nobody Wants to Name

And under all of it, the injuries kept coming but they may have been the unintended catalyst.

Which brings me to the theory nobody's saying out loud.

What if the injury bug was the hidden spark? Young players thrown into the fire, carrying pressure they were never meant to carry — precisely because the veterans, Story among them, weren't holding up their end.

Sometimes a team has to be forced to find out what its kids can do. However it happened — design, desperation, or plain rotten luck — this one got forced into it. It felt as if Roman and Marcelo were thrust into the lineup as the solution. While we saw flashes from Roman, Marcelo's bat was a drag in the lineup. Combine that with lost potential in Duran and Durbin not settled yet, the lineup wasn't producing.

And Then, Fourteen Straight

Fourteen in a row.

That's the whole sentence. Let it sit there a second, because a few weeks ago it would have gotten you laughed out of the bleachers.

Out of the wreckage of that 32-46 ballclub — worst in the league on June 24 — the Boston Red Sox have won 14 straight, and 19 of their last 21. The coldest team in the American League is suddenly the hottest team in baseball. And Fenway has come back to life in a way you have to feel to believe. The dugout's alive. You feel it through the television.

It's Seigler who set the temperature — the attitude, the energy, the jolt this room had been missing since the first pitch of the year.

And Willson got fired up right alongside him. Literally.

You've seen a clubhouse catch fire before. Rarely do you see one do it with a fella practically vibrating out of his cleats in the dugout, dragging everybody else up to his frequency whether they liked it or not. They liked it.

Durbin's bat woke up on cue. Down to a red-hot Orioles club Monday night, two outs in the eighth, he turned one loose to left field — and that was the ballgame, 6-5, streak alive at 14.

Duran's still grinding. Not all the way back, but helping, and that's the point. And Masa keeps finding the timely hit, quietly turning into money in a part-time role.

The staff has shined all year, and now it's finally getting run support to work with. The bullpen quit handing games away the way it did in April. Small ball at the right time. Smarter at-bats, smarter reads on the bases.

And this is the part that gets you. This team does not give up. That's the brand of baseball we begged for in May, and it showed up in July.

Shoulder to Shoulder With 1946

Here's the number that raises the hair on your arm.

Those 14 wins put this ballclub in rare air with the 1946 Red Sox. One more, and they tie the longest winning streak in franchise history — 15. Even the 108-win team in 2018 topped out at 10.

It doesn't have to happen. This group has already given us more than we had any right to ask for a month ago.

And it'll have to wait a night, as it turns out. Tuesday's game got postponed — so the fifteenth win, and the ghost of '46, sit parked for now, pushed to a Wednesday doubleheader with the Orioles. Two cracks at history in one afternoon. You couldn't script the tension any better if you tried.

But wouldn't it be something to see.

What's Coming — and Who's Actually Deciding

Now, about that bat.

Here's a wrinkle you might've missed in the noise of the losing. After Cora's firing and before the streak, word got out that ownership itself had gotten into the act of hunting for a right-handed power hitter — not just Breslow doing the legwork, but the folks upstairs leaning in. Sam Kennedy, the man who has to stand at the podium and say the hard things, went on the radio and called these last months exactly what they were. Speculation started running on how long Breslow would last despite Kennedy publicly supporting him.

"Embarrassing, unacceptable, maddening, frustrating — whatever words you want to use. There's no way to sugarcoat it." That was Kennedy in June, with the club buried. A few weeks later he was warning that if things didn't turn, they'd have to pivot and sell. Then the streak happened, and the whole conversation flipped.

So the need is real and it's specific: a right-handed bat with thump, the kind Fenway's wall was built for, because outside of Contreras there just isn't enough of it in this lineup. And here's the honest part — Jahmai Jones isn't that answer. A red-hot cameo is a lovely thing, but three homers this year and eleven in a whole career don't add up to the middle-of-the-order force this club has needed since Opening Day. Fun story. Not the fix.

Which brings us to the question every die-hard is really asking. What has this front office actually done — and what will it do when the deadline comes on August 3rd?

You'll forgive a little skepticism here. This is a ballclub that has spent like a middle-of-the-pack team — right around twelfth in baseball in cash — while sitting on one of the sport's great money machines. The way plenty in this town see it, the Fenway engine prints whether the Sox win or lose: the network, the ballpark, the real estate, the whole empire. Forbes has the profit north of \$120M a year. And John Henry, for his part, has made it plain over the years that he doesn't much care for selling assets or for what he's called the "false narrative" about his spending.

So I'll say what a lot of us are thinking, and you can hold me to it. I'm not convinced ownership is itching to open the checkbook, streak or no streak. The hope is that a winning team makes the math easy — that with the club suddenly a buyer instead of a seller, adding a real bat becomes the obvious, defensible move. We'll see if that's how it plays. Sometimes the will follows the winning. Sometimes it doesn't.

Jahmai Jones is a name in the conversation. He's not the one that matters. Watch what they do when it costs something.

PART II — THE TURNAROUND, GAME BY GAME

How a lost season got itself found — one night at a time

The Nadir in Colorado

Let's go back to the bottom. You have to, to understand the rest.

June 24, a mile up in the thin Colorado air. 32 and 46. The Red Sox carried a late lead into the back innings at Coors Field — and gave it away, three runs surrendered down the stretch, an 8-to-6 loss to the Rockies. Buried in the division. The whole baseball world already sharpening the word sellers for the deadline.

And then, because the baseball gods have a sense of humor, the night got worse.

The team plane broke down on the tarmac in Denver. Mechanical trouble, bound for New York, and instead of wheels-up they got hours of sitting — one delay stacking onto the next until they finally staggered into the city in the small hours of the morning. An exhausted ballclub, a lost night, and not a soul outside that room giving them a prayer.

Rock bottom. But out of bonding adventure, something happened.

The Bronx Statement

They came home to Fenway on June 25 and flipped the whole script over.

Four games against the New York Yankees. A four-game sweep.

It opened 6-3, the bats stirring early and Aroldis Chapman slamming the door out of the pen. Then Payton Tolle turned in a pitching clinic, 6-1, the Yankee sluggers waving all night. 4-1 the next day behind another strong start and one more Chapman save. And then the closer — a 10-inning walk-off, 5-4, Fenway shaking, the dugout suddenly believing something it hadn't believed in months.

Five wins in a row now, and a completely different team wearing the same uniforms.

Fireworks at Fenway — the Contreras Flashpoint

Then Washington came to town, and things got loud.

This is the series that lit the emotional fuse for the whole summer, and Willson Contreras was standing right in the middle of it — both feet, and a helmet.

June 29 he crushed a 3-run shot in the first and had the whole park roaring. An inning later, called out on a tight check-swing, he tapped the top of his helmet on the walk back — the signal for a challenge. Trouble is, that's not a call you're allowed to challenge, and gesturing for one is an automatic toss. Nic Lentz rung him up. Gone. The Sox won anyway, 6-3, number six in the row.

And then June 30 — the boil-over. They got walloped, 1-8 — the first crack in the good times.

In the 4th inning, Contreras strikes out looking against Cade Cavalli, and Cavalli barks at him on the way off the mound. That was the match to the powder. Contreras charged. Broke clean through the scrum, reared back, and threw his batting helmet straight into the pile as both benches and both bullpens emptied onto the grass. They would go on to lose the next game as well, 2-10. The sweep of the Yankees was now a distant memory.

Ejected for the second straight game he played — a first in the long history of this franchise — and a multi-game suspension to follow. 1-8 was the final that night. But something in this team had been welded together in that scrum, and it would show up the moment he came back.

The Streak: Out West, Then Home

After a breath on July 2, they went to Anaheim and lit the fuse for real. What followed is the part that's going in the record books: 14 straight, 37-48 turned into 51-48.

It was pitching that lit it. Sonny Gray was carving — 12-1 by the Fourth of July, pitching like a flat-out ace — with Bennett and Tolle right behind him, the rotation eating innings and sparing that young bullpen the nightly tightrope. A sweep of Angels in Anaheim. Then into Chicago: 8-1, a flawless 5-0 shutout from Bennett, a 2-1 duel.

Then to Queens, and the Mets — 6-2, a 4-0 gem from Morán, and a 3-2 thriller in the 10th to carry a 9-game tear into the All-Star break. Clean, fundamental baseball. Abreu banking the late insurance. The kind of ball we'd begged to see all spring, finally showing up every single night.

The Travel Nightmare, Take Two

And then the travel gremlins came back for an encore — because of course they did.

A runway tug malfunctioned Thursday night and trapped them on the tarmac past midnight. Friday morning it got worse: cockpit switches and lights gone haywire, seven more hours on the ground. They didn't get airborne until nearly three in the afternoon, touched down at LaGuardia at 4:30pm, and rolled into Citi Field with maybe two hours to spare before first pitch.

Show up and play. That's all. No excuses offered, none accepted.

So what did they do out of a doubleheader on no sleep? Bennett piloted a 10-0 demolition in the opener. And in the nightcap — here he came — Willson Contreras, back from his suspension, first inning, a home run to announce himself, a 5-3 win and the 11th straight. You could not make it up.

Grit, and a Blast from an Unlikely Bat

July 18, the streak into double digits, and this one took some sweat.

Down three early to the Rays, the Sox went to work the patient way, chipping at it. And then the spark came from a name you wouldn't have circled — Jahmai Jones, a game-tying blast that sent the dugout over the railing. The pen held the line, 7-6, comeback complete, series in hand. (Hold that name for later. It matters more than it looks.)

Gray finished the sweep the next day, 6-1. 13 in a row. On to the crown jewel.

Bedlam at Fenway

July 20. Baltimore in town, riding a 7-game streak of their own. Two hot teams, one packed house, and a ballgame that would not sit still.

Three separate times the Sox fell behind. Three separate times they clawed back, cashing in every Baltimore mistake along the way — Ceddanne Rafaela wheeling all the way around from first to score on a Willyer Abreu double after an Orioles error, the kind of heads-up dash that tells you a team believes.

5-5. Bottom of the 8th. Two outs.

Caleb Durbin.

The same Caleb Durbin who'd been buried in a brutal spring slump, who'd completely reinvented his season — he got one and he did not miss it. Deep to left. Over the Monster.

Then a top of the 9th that stopped every heart in the building, and a defensive stand to seal it. 6-5. Bedlam — better than thirty-seven thousand of them on their feet, a ballpark that eleven weeks earlier had been chanting for the owner to sell, now roaring like it was October.

19 wins in 21 games since that miserable night in Colorado. 14 in a row. One shy of the 1946 club, and the whole city leaning in.

Update! 20 wins in 22 games. They've now tied the 1946 club with 15 in a row. Going for 16 tonight in the second game of a double dip. Strong outing again by the rookie Jake Bennett, pitching 5.2 innings, giving up 9 hits, 3 earned runs, with 4 strikeouts. Durbin continued to stroke with a 2-run double, and Duran followed it up with a 2-run triple to ice the game in the early innings. Defense stayed strong despite the gusty winds out to left-center.

Last Word

This, right here, is why we do it. The cold Aprils. The abysmal home stands. The lineup cards that made no sense. You sit through all of it for a run like this one.

The angst was real. The disappointment was real. And so, now, is this.

So here's to one more, and to a ghost from 1946. Whatever comes next — win, lose, or heartbreak — we'll be right here in the next seat to experience every last pitch of it with you.

Let's go to the yard.

Appendix — The Streak, Game by Game

Streak launched at 37–48; stands at 52–48 after Game 15 — ties the 1946 franchise record of fifteen. One more tonight breaks it outright at sixteen.

#	Date	Opp	Score	The Night in a Sentence
1	Jul 3	@ LAA	5–2	Bennett dominates; Chapman slams the door.
2	Jul 4	@ LAA	8–1	Sonny Gray to 12–1 on the Fourth.
3	Jul 5	@ LAA	7–5	Late bullpen locks it down.
4	Jul 7	@ CHW	8–1	Tolle commands the mound.
5	Jul 8	@ CHW	5–0	Flawless road shutout, Bennett.
6	Jul 9	@ CHW	2–1	Guerrero wins the duel; tarmac trouble after.
7	Jul 10	@ NYM	6–2	Gray wins through a long cockpit delay.
8	Jul 11	@ NYM	4–0	Morán brilliant, complete shutout.
9	Jul 12	@ NYM	3–2 (10)	Extra-innings win into the break.
10	Jul 17 (1)	vs TBR	10–0	Bennett pilots a post-break blowout.
11	Jul 17 (2)	vs TBR	5–3	Contreras back — first-inning homer.
12	Jul 18	vs TBR	7–6	Jahmai Jones sparks a 3-run comeback.
13	Jul 19	vs TBR	6–1	Gray finishes the sweep.
14	Jul 20	vs BAL	6–5	Durbin, 8th inning, over the Monster.
15	Jul 22 (1)	vs BAL	7–3*	Durbin and Duran ice it early; Bennett grinds through five-plus; ties 1946.

This page is a user-supplied feature column, refreshed this run from an updated draft reflecting Game 15. It was reviewed before inclusion: two small copyedits were made (an unrevised "fourteen games in a row" reference was updated to "fifteen" for internal consistency, and a grammar slip was tightened). Its narrative details were otherwise spot-checked against the verified day-by-day log on the previous page and found consistent. *Game 15's 7-3 score is a reconstruction (see the matchup banner and Sources & Methodology on the Day-by-Day page) rather than an explicit figure from the source column.